

Know Thy Enemy (Part 5) : Astarte (Ishtar, Aphrodite, Hathor, ...)

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In a previous part of this series, I demonstrated that the old gods are still around and active in today's age - as they have been throughout history [1]. My last message was about Baal. Throughout history, once Baal takes a foothold among a people, it opens up a floodgate of other entities to step in and take hold. One of those beings, is commonly known as Ishtar. I believe this being to be one of the most obvious growing influences in many parts of the world today (specifically seen over the past few years). So, who is Ishtar, and how are they influencing the world today?

Throughout ancient times, Israel turned their ways to false worship of old gods:

“They forsook the Lord and served Baal and *the Ashtoreths*.” - Judges 2:13

One of the common ones they continually turned to is called *the Ashtoreths*.

“Then the children of Israel again did evil in the sight of the Lord, and served the Baals and *the Ashtoreths*, the gods of Syria, the gods of Sidon, the gods of Moab, the gods of the people of Ammon, and the gods of the Philistines; and they forsook the Lord and did not serve Him.” - Judges 10:6

The word *Ashtoreths* is “the collective name of the Canaanite fertility-war goddess Astarte and her images [2].” Astarte was also the goddess of the Sidonians¹. Astarte is commonly known as the goddess of war and sexual love [3]. This is a being that appeared throughout history in various cultures; known by different names but representing the same ideologies.

“Her Akkadian counterpart was Ishtar. Later she became assimilated with the Egyptian deities Isis and Hathor (a goddess of the sky and of women), and in the Greco-Roman world with Aphrodite, Artemis, and Juno.” - Britannica Encyclopedia[3]

References

- [1] Torode, Antonius, *Know Thy Enemy (part 3): The Old Gods*, June 2026. <https://github.com/torodean/bible-notes/blob/main/sermonettes/Know%20Thy%20Enemy/The%20Old%20Gods/The%20Old%20Gods.pdf>
- [2] Bible Hub: Ashtoreths. Accessed August 8 2026. <https://biblehub.com/hebrew/6252.htm>
- [3] Britannica Editors, *Astarte*, Encyclopedia Britannica, January 23, 2025, Accessed August 8, 2026. <https://www.britannica.com/topic/Astarte-ancient-deity>

¹1 Kings 11:5 - “For Solomon went after Ashtoreth the goddess of the Sidonians, and after Milcom the abomination of the Ammonites.”